



PROJECT SANCTUM

A UI / UX DESIGN DOCUMENT

The design system behind a network hidden in plain sight — architecture, ritual, tokens, type, motion, interaction, resilience, and the three arcs that make visitors stay.

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THE TWO-LAYER HOUSE

LAYER I - THE COVER

SIGNAL & STATIC — an abandoned shortwave listener’s blog, est. 2008, last transmission March 2013. Serif, justified columns, a dead guestbook, a hit counter at 001337, webrings. It is its own complete website — believable enough to be judged standing alone.

LAYER II - THE SANCTUM

The hidden network: a boot Seal, a scroll-driven Gate transmission, a draggable rite-orbit, six chambers, a Ceremony, a Departure, and a Field Log dossier — all behind the door, all client-side, all remembered between visits.

THE JOURNEY, TOPOLOGICALLY



WHY TWO LAYERS

Discovery is the product. The cover is **airtight** — no custom cursor, no chrome, no glow leaks: the native arrow pointer is itself part of the disguise. Only finding the door proves the world existed at all, which retroactively re-reads every blog post as a clue. One key, **~**, panics back to the surface instantly from anywhere — cover and Sanctum are a single toggleable reality.

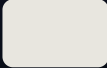
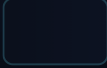
THE UNLOCK RITUAL

#	STEP	DESIGN INTENT
01	READ THE BLOG	Posts are real field notes (UVB-76, the Wow! signal). One — <i>the hum at 0528</i> — teaches the four-digit frequency without ever breaking character.
02	OPEN PHOTOS	Six frames: five plausible, one impossible — a glowing ring in a dead observatory, captioned IMG_0528 — DO NOT .
03	CLICK THE RING ×3	Each click: static flicker, a notch of brightness, a detuning whisper-blip. Escalation earns commitment — three is a ritual, not an accident.
04	THE DOOR ASKS	The page tears open into a code field. Enter 0528 — the blog itself taught it. A static wipe cuts to the Seal bootloader.
05	GIVE YOUR NAME	First entry asks once: <i>"the network must know what to call you."</i> Persisted forever — every later visit opens with WELCOME BACK, {name} .

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

The password is taught, never told. Every element of the ritual is diegetic — the code lives in a story, the door lives in a photograph, the instruction lives in a caption that says the opposite. Security through lore.

DESIGN TOKENS

 INK #07090F · void ground	 KYBER #67E8F9 · the signal · rite I
 KYBER-DIM #2E8FA3 · secondary labels	 EMBER #E8B44C · ritual + rite III
 VIOLET #B79CFF · rite II · identity tinge	 BONE #E8E6DF · foreground copy
 GHOST #9AA3B2 · subdued chrome	 PANEL #0B101C→#0D1322 · card ground

RULE

TOKEN LAW

COLOR = DOMAINS	kyber owns Signal, violet owns Focus, ember owns Choice & the ritual. A glance tells you which system speaks.
ONE GLOW BUDGET	glows stay under 34px blur and 30% alpha; darkness is the default state, light is earned.
BORDERS AT 10-16%	structure lines hold at low alpha — the interface feels etched, not boxed.

TYPOGRAPHY

DISPLAY - CINZEL

THE TRIALS OF AWAKENING

Imperial serified caps for ranks, rites and the wordmark — clamp(30px–76px), weight 700–900, tracking .08–.14em, steel-gradient fill.

BODY - SPACE GROTESK

Hear what hides beneath the static. Hold the beacon while the void pulls.

Interface copy at 12–15px, light weight, 1.6–1.75 leading — quiet, technical, readable against ink.

SYSTEM - IBM PLEX MONO

◆ TRANSMISSION 03/03 - IDENTITY DISCLOSED

Kickers, HUD, codes and quest rows at 8.5–12px with .2–.42em tracking — the network’s own voice.

ROLE	SIZE	TRACKING
Display / ranks	clamp 30–76px	.08–.2em
Body / hints	12.5–15px	.01–.14em
Mono / kickers	8.5–12px	.2–.5em

MOTION LANGUAGE

SIGNATURE	DURATION / EASE	BEHAVIOUR
SCRAMBLE DECODE	16-70ms/char · linear	Every message arrives as glyph-noise sweeping left→right into truth — decryption as typography.
STATIC WIPE	.36s · steps(5)	Layer changes (blog ⇌ Sanctum) cut through full-screen static — a channel change, not a page load.
RITE ORBIT	.55s · power3 / back.out	Three rites ride a 3D carousel with real throw physics — drags carry inertia, wheels notch by 120° with a mechanical tick.
SIGIL BLOOM	.7s · cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1)	Identity arcs draw on one-by-one, staggered 110ms — a louder record draws a denser mark.
RANK SLAM	.62s · power4.in	The ceremony's rank lands from 3× scale with an impact, a flash and a seven-frame shake.
THE FOLD	scroll-driven · smoothstep	Departure transmissions dissolve reversed — blur, tracking-out, and lift compose the forgetting.

TWO LAWS

I. Wall-clock gates, rAF paints. Anything that scores or gates (seal lift, quest fires, wave timers) reads real elapsed time; animation only mirrors it — throttled tabs never corrupt a verdict.

II. State-driven entrances. Motion begins after the interface commits, so a reopened chamber replays its theater cleanly every time.

INTERACTION MODEL

KEYBOARD MAP

KEY	ACTION
~	panic — blog ⇌ Sanctum, instantly, anywhere
Esc / burger	open the Field Log dossier
1-5	Field Log tab jump
↑ ↑ ↓ ↓	lift the Seal at once (knowing hands only)
Ctrl+Alt+D	forget everything — full registry wipe
wheel / drag	spin the rite-orbit, steer every chamber

THE CURSOR SPEAKS

One ring cursor, a labeled aura — BEGIN · REPLAY · SEALED · APPROACH · DRAG · TUNE · HOLD · CHOOSE · DEPART · RETURN — so intent is announced before the click.

THE NAME REGISTRY

Asked once, kept forever. The Seal greets WELCOME BACK, {name}; after the Ceremony it greets by callsign. Identity persists across sessions, upgrades, and the Departure itself.

PERSISTENCE

Every rite score, quest, mote, path walked, streak best, rank and sigil lives in a versioned local save — migrate-safe, offline-first, zero accounts, zero servers. Your legend survives the browser closing.

THE FIELD LOG

One Esc from anywhere: a five-tab dossier — IDENTITY (sigil · rank · totals) · TASK LOG (rites & echoes) · QUESTS (nineteen, with live progress) · ARCHIVE (restored fragments & walked paths) · SIGNAL (attunement & mute). It reads the same truthful save; it never invents state.

ACCESSIBILITY & RESILIENCE

SURFACE	PROVISION
REDUCED MOTION	<code>prefers-reduced-motion</code> collapses ambient theater (orbits idle, pulses still, wipes flatten) while every control, scroll-journey and verdict stays fully operable.
AUDIO BY CONSENT	The sound engine arms on the visitor's first gesture — never autoplaying, never surprising — and a persistent mute lives in the Field Log's SIGNAL tab.
CONTRAST	Bone-on-ink body text holds $\approx 13:1$; kyber-on-ink $\approx 11:1$; ghost text is decorative or redundant only — meaning never rests on the dimmest ink.
TOUCH PARITY	Every drag has a wheel/tap twin: the orbit notches on scroll, chambers accept taps, no mechanic requires a right hand.
GPU GRACE	If WebGL is absent the portal degrades itself to a pure-CSS rite ("TURBINE MODE") with the same beats, copy and scoring — the journey never gates on hardware.
FAIL-SOFT SAVE	The registry migrates forward across versions; a corrupt state refuses to hard-lock the door — the cover re-opens and the ritual re-teaches itself.

THE STANCE

Mystery is a mood, not a barrier. Everything secret in SANCTUM is discoverable by design — and everything essential is reachable by anyone.

HEARTS · MINDS · WALLETS

HEARTS

WHY IT MOVES

Melancholy first: a dead blog, a keeper who stopped transmitting in 2013. Then the impossible photograph — and the visitor is no longer browsing, they are trespassing. The network asks their name and never forgets it. The Ceremony speaks their callsign aloud; the Departure lets them grieve leaving. Emotion is engineered as a sequence: curiosity → trespass → belonging → legacy.

MINDS

WHY IT TEACHES

Signal trains real ears — tuning against drift, dual-voice separation, a 26-detent cipher wheel. Focus is attention made physical, including a decoy that punishes the fooled. Choice models consequence without preaching: every verdict immediately becomes a playable proof. Nineteen quests reward the precise behaviors of a curious mind — read everything, walk both sides of tomorrow, come back faster.

WALLETS

WHY IT LASTS

Zero install, zero accounts, zero servers — a static build that runs anywhere a browser does and persists forever on-device. Replayability is systemic: an endless master band, six walkable paths, rank promotions, a sigil that is provably yours. And the two-layer *cover + rite* architecture is a format, not a one-off — any world can hide behind anything.

THE SYNTHESIS

Feel like you found something forbidden · learn like the machine trusts you · keep what you earned forever — **THAT IS THE WHOLE LEDGER.**

WE HIDE IN PLAIN SIGHT

TEAM CCA — PROJECT SANCTUM

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